

Google Pixel 9

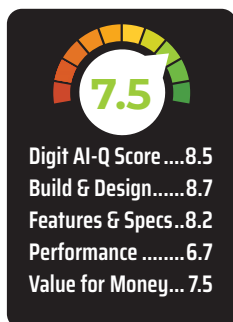
Limited performance, limitless AI possibilities

In a market flooded with AI-ready smartphones, the Pixel 9 series made me sit up and take notice of its host of new AI features. The features this year are not just flashy but functional as well. But, a great phone isn't just about impressive AI; it's also about how well the device performs overall. With the Pixel 9, Google is aiming to offer a solid package with its new Tensor G4 processor, sleek design, vibrant display, and smooth user experience. However, it's up against some serious competition like the iQOO 12 and OnePlus 12, which provide excellent value for money. While the Pixel 9 looks promising on paper, there are a few things that might give potential buyers pause, like the UFS 3.1 storage and slower charging speeds. In this review, I'll dive into all aspects of the Pixel 9 — from its build and design to its display, performance, software, AI features, cameras, and battery life — to see if it truly measures up to the hype.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Google Pixel 9 nails it when it comes to looks and feel. It's got this sleek, matte aluminium frame with nicely rounded corners that make it both stylish and durable. It feels pretty solid in your hand, weighing in at 198 grams, and I think the added heftiness is not a bad thing; it makes the phone feel a tad more premium. The 6.3-inch flat display is just the right size for most folks — not too big, not too small — fitting comfortably without being a bulky pocket monster like some other phones out there.

₹79,999



I got for this review, looks minimalist and classy, standing out in a good way. The redesigned camera module is also sleeker than before, but it still sticks out quite a bit. Thankfully, it's not wobbly when you lay it flat.

One of the coolest upgrades is the ultrasonic fingerprint sensor — it's lightning-fast and super responsive. On the downside, there's a fairly large punch-hole cutout for the front camera, which is a bit of a letdown, especially considering the phone's price. Overall, though, the Pixel 9 looks and feels

great, blending practicality with a modern aesthetic.

DISPLAY

The Pixel 9's 6.3-inch OLED display is sharp and has good colour accuracy, making it good enough for daily use. But don't expect all the bells and whistles you get from some of the high-end displays out there. First off, it's not an LTPO panel and secondly, it only supports 8-bit colour depth, which means it can't quite match the richer hues of 10 or 12-bit panels and it doesn't have dynamic refresh rates as well.

That said, it still looks pretty good in most situations. HDR videos pop with vivid colours, and the brightness is solid, even outdoors. It can hit up to 2700 nits at peak brightness, but on Auto-Brightness Mode, it hovered around 1682 nits in our tests, which is still quite impressive. Just a heads up — the 120Hz refresh rate is turned off by default, so make sure you switch it on for a smoother experience. As for the speakers, they are clear, but they could use a bit more punch in the bass department.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Performance has always been a bit of a mixed bag for Google's Pixel phones, and the Pixel 9 is no different. It's powered by the Tensor G4 processor, which is definitely an improvement over its predecessor, but it still doesn't quite keep up with some of its rivals. In benchmark tests, it trails behind phones like the iQOO 12 and OnePlus 12 and even scores lower than some mid-range devices like the Realme GT 6T. Sure, it matches up with the OnePlus 12 in some areas, but overall, it's not leading the pack.

When you really push it, the Pixel 9 shows its limits. During a 15-minute CPU throttling test, it dropped to 58% of its peak performance, similar to the Exynos-powered Samsung Galaxy S24. This means it handles everyday tasks just fine but struggles when things get intense, leading to some throttling